AI AND YOUR FINANCES

Can't AI just be my CFO?

It's a fair question, and we hear it from owners often. AI is a big part of how we work. Here is what it does well, where it goes wrong, and why the best results come from a person who knows finance and knows the tools.

What AI is good at

- **Repetitive work.** Sorting and coding transactions, matching payments, drafting routine reports.
- **Speed.** Reading a year of ledger detail in minutes and pointing to what looks unusual.
- **Explaining.** Turning a financial statement into plain English, or answering "what does this ratio mean?"
- **First drafts.** A budget template, a cash flow model, a list of questions for your banker.

We use it for all of these, every day. It makes us faster and it catches things a tired person would miss.

Where it goes wrong on its own

- **It answers the question you ask.** It does not know which question you should have asked. If you do not know to ask about loan covenants, unbilled work, or payroll tax deposits, they will not come up.
- **It can be confidently wrong.** A wrong answer reads exactly like a right one. Telling them apart takes someone who knows what right looks like.
- **It only knows what it is given.** If the books are wrong, the analysis built on them is wrong too. It will not notice that a payment was recorded twice unless someone checks the books against the bank.
- **It does not know your business.** Your banker, your best customer, the job that always runs over, the hire you are nervous about. Context like that lives with people.
- **It is not accountable.** When the lender, the IRS, or a buyer has questions, a person has to stand behind the numbers.

Speaking the language matters

Getting good work out of AI is a skill, and in finance it depends on knowing the subject. An experienced accountant knows what to ask for, recognizes an answer that cannot be right, and knows which numbers to tie back to a source document before anyone relies on them. Without that, an owner is left trusting output they have no way to check.

Three ways to use AI for your finances

	HOW IT TENDS TO GO	THE CATCH
AI on its own	Fast answers to whatever you ask.	Nobody checks the inputs or the answers, and nobody is accountable for them.
You, using AI yourself	Better, because you know your business.	It takes your time, and you still have to judge accounting and tax answers outside your field.
An experienced accountant using AI	The speed of AI, with someone who knows what to ask and what to check.	You pay for a person. In return, someone owns the result.

Five questions before you rely on AI

1. Would you know if the answer were wrong?
2. Are the books it is reading accurate and reconciled?
3. Who is accountable if a tax or lender number is off?
4. Is your financial data going into a tool that keeps it private?
5. Is this the best use of your own time?

How we use it

- ✓ AI reviews your books line by line, and a person reviews what it finds.
- ✓ Automation handles the repetitive work, so closes are faster.
- ✓ Your reporting dashboard is built from your own QuickBooks data.
- ✓ We work through a business AI account, under terms that do not use your data to train its models.

The short answer

AI will not replace your CFO, but a finance team that uses AI well will outperform one that does not. Our team has years of hands-on accounting and finance experience, including a licensed CPA, and we have built our work around these tools. You get the speed of the technology and the judgment of people who know what the numbers should say.

Want us to look at your numbers?

Our discovery review is free, and the written findings are yours to keep. Start at **regaliahillsconsulting.com** or email **john@regaliahillsconsulting.com**.

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